We strongly recommend using high-availability deployment for all databases that handle production workloads. If you want to save money, you can choose not to deploy a highly available database for your test systems.

If the primary database becomes unavailable due to hardware or network failures, RDS starts the failover process. The standby database then becomes the primary database. As figure 10.6 shows, the DNS name is updated and clients begin to use the former standby database for their requests.

RDS detects the need for a failover automatically and executes it without human intervention.

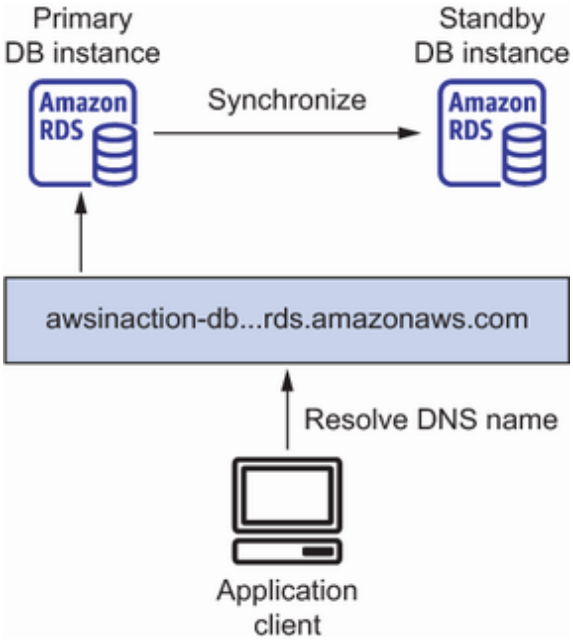


Figure 10.5 The primary database is replicated to the standby database when running in high-availability mode.